Tsunamis and Your Safety

For Everyone
AUG. 25, 2026, VISIT LINK FOR DETAILS.
ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- Learn more about tsunamis and get information about health concerns after a tsunami including food and water safety.
- Know how to prepare for a tsunami and how to stay safe during and after one.

Prepare for tsunamis



Know how to prepare for a tsunami and how to stay safe during and after one.

Tsunamis, also known as seismic sea waves, are a series of enormous waves created by an underwater disturbance such as an earthquake, landslide, volcanic eruption, or meteorite. A tsunami can strike anywhere along most of the U.S. coastline.

Know how to prepare for a tsunami and how to stay safe during and after one.

Ready.gov- Tsunamis
NOAA Tsunamis
NOAA Tsunami Program
Red Cross Tsunami Preparedness
U.S. Tsunami Warning System
EPA Tsunami

Stay safe after a tsunami

After a tsunami, you may face a number of hazards to your health. Know what to do to protect yourself and your loved ones after a tsunami.

Protect yourself from floodwater.

Floodwater and standing water can be dangerous and can make you vulnerable to infectious diseases, chemical hazards, and injuries. Floodwater can also pose a drowning risk for everyone— regardless of their ability to swim. Swiftly moving shallow water can be deadly, and even shallow standing water can be dangerous for small children.

- Stay out of floodwater—it can contain many things that can hurt you or make you sick.
- Always follow warnings about flooded roads.
- Don't drive in flooded areas—cars or other vehicles won't protect you from floodwaters. They can be swept away or may stall in moving water.

KEEP READINGSafety Guidelines: Floodwater

Protect your physical health.

After a tsunami, there are a number of hazards that can make you sick or hurt you. Know how to protect yourself and others from injury or illness after a disaster.

KEEP READINGWhat to Do to Prevent Getting Hurt or Sick After a Disaster

Clean up safely.

- Take steps to protect yourself and your loved ones during your cleanup after a tsunami.
- Follow our cleanup tips and monitor your radio or television

for up-to-date emergency information.

KEEP READINGGuidelines for Cleaning Safely After a Disaster

Take care of your emotional health.

During and after a disaster, it is natural to experience different and strong emotions. Coping with these feelings and getting help when you need it will help you, your family, and your community recover from a disaster.

Contact SAMHSA's Disaster Distress Helpline

Disaster Distress Helpline: CALL or TEXT 1-800-985-5990 (press 2 for Spanish). People with deafness or hearing loss can use their preferred relay service to call 1-800-985-5990.

- Connect with family, friends, and others in your community.
- Take care of yourself and each other, and know when and how to seek help.